



READING COMPREHENSION

KU30003_English III TOEFL Preparation Class

Week 13_Session 1



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OUTLINE

- Strategies for TOEFL Reading Comprehension – Skill 3-5

REVIEW

- Which of the strategies of 'main idea' or 'organisation of ideas' do you find easier to do?

OBJECTIVE

Students are able to correctly answer questions in Reading comprehension section in TOEFL ITP-like test using the following strategies:

Skill 3: answer stated detailed questions correctly

Skill 4: find 'unstated' details

Skill 5: find pronoun referents

STRATEGIES FOR THE READING COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS:

- ✓ Reading Comprehension consists of 50 questions for 55 minutes.
- ✓ FAQ: main ideas, directly answered questions (based on the text), implications of the text, and vocabulary.
- ✓ Be familiar with the directions.
- ✓ Do **not spend too much time** on the reading.
- ✓ The texts might be about **something unfamiliar to you**, but do not worry because all the information you need is in the text.
- ✓ Never leave any answer blank.

STRATEGIES IN READING

- Skimming: To find main ideas or gist of the text
- Scanning: To find specific information/detail (use keywords)
- Check out the questions first to determine the type of the questions and what information needs to find
- Read the passage which contains the answer carefully
- Choose the best answer

READING COMPREHENSION

SKILL 3: ANSWER STATED DETAILED QUESTIONS CORRECTLY

- **Common Questions:**

According to the passage, ..

It is stated in the passage

- **Where to Find the Answer**

The answers to these questions are found in order in the passage.

SKILL 3: ANSWER STATED DETAILED QUESTIONS CORRECTLY

How to answer

1. Choose a **keyword** in the question.
2. Skim in the **appropriate part of the passage** for the keyword or idea.
3. **Read** the sentence that contains the keyword or idea carefully.
4. **Look for the answer** that restates an idea in the passage.
5. **Eliminate the definitely wrong answers** and choose the best answer from the remaining choices.
6. Never leave any answer blank.

SKILL 3

Example

The passage:

Line
(5)

Williamsburg is a historic city in Virginia situated on a peninsula between two rivers, the York and the James. It was settled by English colonists in 1633, twenty-six years after the first permanent English colony in America was settled at Jamestown. In the beginning the colony at Williamsburg was named Middle Plantation because of its location in the middle of the peninsula. The site for Williamsburg had been selected by the colonists because the soil drainage was better there than at the Jamestown location, and there were fewer mosquitoes.

The questions:

1. According to the passage, Williamsburg is located
 - (A) on an island
 - (B) in the middle of a river
 - (C) where the York and the James meet
 - (D) on a piece of land with rivers on two sides
2. The passage indicates that Jamestown
 - (A) was settled in 1633
 - (B) was settled twenty-six years after Williamsburg
 - (C) was the first permanent English colony in America
 - (D) was originally named Middle Plantation
3. The passage states that the name Middle Plantation
 - (A) is a more recent name than Williamsburg
 - (B) derived from the location of the colony on the peninsula
 - (C) refers to the middle part of England that was home to the colonists
 - (D) was given to the new colony because it was located in the middle of several plantations

SKILL 4: FIND 'UNSTATED' DETAILS

- **Common questions**

- Which of the following is not stated ... ?
- Which of the following is not mentioned .. ?
- All of the following statements are true except ... ?

Where to Find the Answer

The answers to these questions are found in order in the passage.

SKILL 4: FIND 'UNSTATED' DETAILS

How to answer

1. Choose a **keyword** in the question.
2. Scan in the **appropriate part of the passage** for the keyword or idea.
3. **Read** the sentence that contains the keyword or idea carefully.
4. Look for the answer that **are definitely true according to** the passage.
Eliminate those answers an idea in the passage.
5. Choose the answer **that is not true or not discussed** from the remaining choices.
6. Never leave any answer blank.

SKILL 4

Example

The passage:

In English there are many different kinds of expressions that people use to give a name to anything whose name is unknown or momentarily forgotten. The word *gadget* is one such word. It was first used by British sailors in the 1850s and probably came from the French word *gachette*, which was a small hook. In everyday use, the word has a more general meaning. Other words are also used to give a name to something unnamed or unknown, and these words tend to be somewhat imaginative. Some of the more commonly used expressions are a *what-d'ye-call-it*, a *whatsis*, a *thingamabob*, a *thingamajig*, a *doodad*, or a *doohickey*.

The questions:

- Which of the following is NOT true about the word "gadget"?
 - It is used to name something when the name is not known.
 - It was used at the beginning of the nineteenth century.
 - It most likely came from a word in the French language.
 - Its first known use was by British sailors.
- Which of the following is NOT mentioned in the passage as an expression for something that is not known?
 - A *thingamabob*
 - A *gadget*
 - A *doohickey*
 - A *what-is-it*

SKILL 5: FIND PRONOUN REFERENTS

- **Common Questions:**

The pronoun ‘...’ in line X refers to which of the following?

- **Where to Find the Answer**

The line where the pronoun is located is generally given in the question. The noun that the pronoun refers to is generally found before the pronoun.

SKILL 5: FIND PRONOUN REFERENTS

How to answer

1. Find the pronoun in the passage (usually stated in the question).
2. Look for the **nouns that come before the pronoun**.
3. **Read** the part of the passage before the pronoun carefully.
4. **Eliminate any definitely wrong answers** and choose the best answer from the remaining choices.
5. Never leave any answer blank.

SKILL 5

Example

The passage:

Line (5) Carnivorous plants, such as the sundew and the Venus flytrap, are generally found in humid areas where there is an inadequate supply of nitrogen in the soil. In order to survive, these plants have developed mechanisms to trap insects within their foliage. They have digestive fluids to obtain the necessary nitrogen from the insects. These plants trap the insects in a variety of ways. The sundew has sticky hairs on its leaves; when an insect lands on these leaves, it gets caught up in the sticky hairs, and the leaf wraps itself around the insect. The leaves of the Venus flytrap function (10) more like a trap, snapping suddenly and forcefully shut around an insect.

The questions:

1. The pronoun "they" in line 5 refers to
 - (A) humid areas
 - (B) these plants
 - (C) insects
 - (D) digestive fluids
2. The pronoun "it" in line 8 refers to
 - (A) a variety
 - (B) the sundew
 - (C) an insect
 - (D) the leaf

REFERENCE:

Philips, D. (2003). *Longman Preparation Course for the TOEFL Test*.
New york: Pearson Education